

Coaching, Therapy, Consulting, and Mentoring: A Comparison



	Coaching	Therapy	Consulting	Mentoring
Focus	The individual	The individual	The organization or individual in relationship to the organization	The individual
Goal	Self-improvement	Understand how past trauma affects current thinking and behavior	Solution to an organizational problem	Passing on information and skills to another
Format	Usually one-to-one	Usually one-to-one	May involve many individuals	Usually one-to-one but may involve other individuals
Engagement	Coach comes up with the initial solutions, but the ultimate goal is for the client to come up with his or her own solutions	Therapist suggests solutions	Consultant is responsible for gathering information and solutions (advice)	Mentor is responsible for training another, sometimes younger, person
Professional's role	Personal	Personal	Strategic	Succession training
Issues discussed	May be personal	Personal, sometimes with emphasis on past events	Organizational	Skills, strategies, and challenges for improving the performance of the mentee
Environment	Private	Private	Mostly public	Usually private
Key to success	Relationship and client motivation	Relationship and ability of the therapist	Strategic thinking, motivation of management	Relationship and ability of the mentee to understand new information
Relationship requirements	Need for trust mutual respect, openness, courage	Need for trust openness, courage	Need for trust, openness, courage	Trust openness, respect, courage
Source: Leni Wildflower, PhD.				